

Week 03 Live Data Visualisation

Documentation

I decided to use the emotional data I captured when picking up my phone for this live data sketch, but I turned it into a time-based system rather than a static picture. I created the illusion of an ongoing, real-time experience by allowing the emotions to cycle continuously, even though my dataset is not live from an external source. I selected this strategy because my data is already linked to recurring behaviors and everyday routines, which are inherently related to rhythm and time.

I gave each emotion a distinct color, face expression, and behavior in order to link the data to visual components. For instance, red tones represent stress, blue tones represent fatigue, and brilliant yellow tones represent excitement. Without using words, these color selections aid in conveying emotional intensity. The animation over time depicts the repetition of my routines, while the size and location of the face stay constant to maintain the focus on emotional transformation. Raw data is transformed into a narrative flow by the emotions' sequencing, which reflects the order in which they were collected.

Aspects of the data that cannot be revealed by numbers or pictures alone are revealed by the sketch. The spectator starts to identify trends by observing the emotions loop, such as the frequency with which "tired" appears or the speed at which emotions change from positive to negative. As a result, the data is better understood emotionally rather than just visually. The repetition almost becomes hypnotic, reflecting the automatic and routine nature of phone use in real life.

It is crucial to consider the connection between the rhythm of the data and the visual rhythm. The sluggish frame rate mimics how I unintentionally check my phone throughout the day by producing a serene but repeated cycle. My feelings can change swiftly, as evidenced by the brief appearance of each emotion before moving on to the next. In contrast to my hand-drawn portrait, which just records a single instant, this temporal component makes the experience more engaging.

Similar to "vibe coding," I used coding as an experimental tool in my workflow to test concepts and make necessary adjustments. I gained knowledge about how to connect data to visual outputs like color and animation, as well as how to organize data in arrays and objects. This made it easier for me to see how motion and interaction can make basic information more interesting.

If I had more time, I would expand on this by incorporating user interactivity, such letting viewers choose particular feelings or adjust the speed. To increase the emotional impact, I would also think about incorporating motion or sound elements. All things considered, this project made it clearer to me how even modest personal datasets may be transformed into dynamic, time-based visualizations